

could have done worse if they'd tried. Again, I point this out as an illustration of the inherent folly in the general attempt at economic forecasting, as opposed to any deficiency of these aforementioned forecasters in particular.

I called up Mr. Dorfman for a confirmation of Mr. Crawford's genius at picking the direction of the markets, only to discover that Mr. Dorfman had cooled considerably on the astrologer. "At one time he had a terrific record," said the Wall Street reporter. "I wrote him up in my column. After that, I found he would change his mind on any given day. It got so bad I had to accept the premise that Mr. Crawford wasn't very good."

Even after hearing that sour news, I would have taken Mr. Crawford's word over Mr. Kaufman's, and, in fact, I phoned the astrologer to ask for his latest planetary prediction. The trouble was that Mr. Crawford was momentarily befuddled. "If the market goes down the next two days, I'll give a buy signal," he said. "That would last for two or three weeks. But if the market goes up, I'll give a short-term sell signal. Then if we build a better base, I'll give a blanket buy signal." At that, I threw up my hands, and went off to look for Ivan Boesky.